FUNDRAISING

Food delivery service Calo scores $39M in Series B extension as it sets eyes on the UK

Ivan Mehta — 4:35 AM PDT · July 29, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: CALO

Middle Eastern food delivery startup Calo said Tuesday it has raised $39 million in a Series B extension that was led by Aljazira Capital. The fundraise, which was more than 1.5x of its original [$25 million raise in December](), also saw participation from existing backers such as Nuwa Capital, STV, Khwarizmi Ventures, and Al Faisaliah Group.

The company is using this funding to expand into territories like the U.K. and to explore different partnerships in physical space.

Calo primarily offers ready-to-eat meals that customers can heat up later. The company delivers different plans to cater to various health goals. The company's founder, Ahmed Al Rawi, told TechCrunch the startup's revenue grew by "close to 100%." Calo delivered more than 10 million meals last year in Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Kuwait, Qatar, and Bahrain. While Al Rawi didn't provide a number for this year, he said the deliveries were growing in step with revenue.

Those numbers, along with its brand, technology, and operational excellence, convinced Aljazira Capital to invest in the Saudi company. "Calo represents a compelling opportunity at the intersection of healthtech, foodtech, and consumer subscription models," Rawan AlRasheed, director of venture capital at Aljazira Capital, told TechCrunch in a statement.

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The startup is also making moves to expand in the U.K., where last year it acquired two meal delivery services, Fresh Fitness Food and Detox Kitchen. While Fresh Fitness Food didn't raise any money, Detox Kitchen had raised just over $3.4 million via a mix of venture-backed and equity crowdfunding rounds, according to Crunchbase data.

"We spoke to over 50 meal subscription businesses worldwide, ranging from the U.S. to Asia, in 2023-24 to learn about what is an exciting market for us to expand to. We realized the UK was the right market for us to expand. We thought that both companies that we acquired had a great culture fit to work with Calo," Al Rawi told TechCrunch over a call.

He added that Calo acquired these businesses because they had their operational layer figured out, and the startup just wanted to upscale the tech and branding layer.

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Al Rawi said Calo spent most of this year integrating its technology and process with both U.K. platforms without laying off any of the existing personnel. The startup finished the integration work in July and has been slowly making a marketing push in the U.K.

Calo can currently deliver meals in London daily and in other parts of the U.K. two to three times a week. The founder said that Calo is targeting to get to 10x its revenue in the U.K. in the next three years.

Those U.K. ambitions will be met with competition. Apart from traditional food delivery giants like Just Eat and Deliveroo, Calo will also compete with meal-box services such as Gousto and Wicked Kitchen.

While Calo is focused on growing in the U.K., the company is also looking to acquire different meal-kit services around the world. The company is expanding physical locations, too, including retail stores and kiosks in other regions. In addition, Calo has partnered with a gym chain called Armah Sports Company in Saudi Arabia to offer a bundle of Calo and gym subscriptions.

Topics: food delivery Fundraising gcc meal kits Nuwa Capital

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IMAGE CREDITS: BREX

FINTECH

IPO hopeful Brex scored major win to sell in the EU, plans UK expansion

Julie Bort — 11:52 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

Financial services provider Brex on Thursday announced that it achieved a major milestone: It is now licensed in the European Union. That means it can now directly issue credit and debit cards and offer its spend management products to any business in all 30 EU countries with "no workarounds required," as co-founder and CEO Pedro Franceschi wrote in a blog post.

While the corporate spend management startup previously supported 60 currencies in 200 countries, it could only sell its products to companies with a U.S. presence.

With the expansion, Brex is now authorized to sell spend management (complete with issuing cards) and other tools like embedded payments to EU companies and startups, a spokesperson tells TechCrunch. However, there's a caveat: Banking and bill pay will not be initially available. The company hopes to roll those services out in the future.

While this is good news for Brex, it may also be good news for European startups. Brex's claim to fame is offering startups expense management cards for their employees even if they wouldn't yet qualify from traditional banks. Without a bank account offering, the youngest EU startups will still have to weigh their options.

Next up, Franceschi says he wants to expand Brex in the U.K., though he offered no specifics on those plans.

Franceschi said in December that Brex is on track to stop burning cash in 2025, "an important milestone to our future IPO."

In February, sources told various news outlets that Brex was on track for $500 million in revenue this year as well. That's quite the turnaround from a shaky moment in 2023 when Brex conducted layoffs and reportedly told employees that its cash burn was too high. There has been no hint yet as to when that IPO may take place, though.

Brex's competitive win in the international market comes as its U.S. fintech competitors are having an overall moment. Ramp has been raising money from VCs like mad, hitting a $22.5 billion valuation just 45 days after a round with a $16 billion valuation. In March, Mercury raised a fresh $300 million and doubled its valuation to $3.5 billion.

Brex has not publicly announced new equity VC funding since 2022, when it raised $300 million in a Series D-2 round at a $12.3 billion valuation. It did, however, sell a fresh $260 million of bonds in March 2024, packaged from its spend management receivables which are used to manage that cash-intensive business.

Topics: Brex european startups Fintech spend management Startups

Julie Bort

Venture Editor

Julie Bort is the Startups/Venture Desk editor for TechCrunch....

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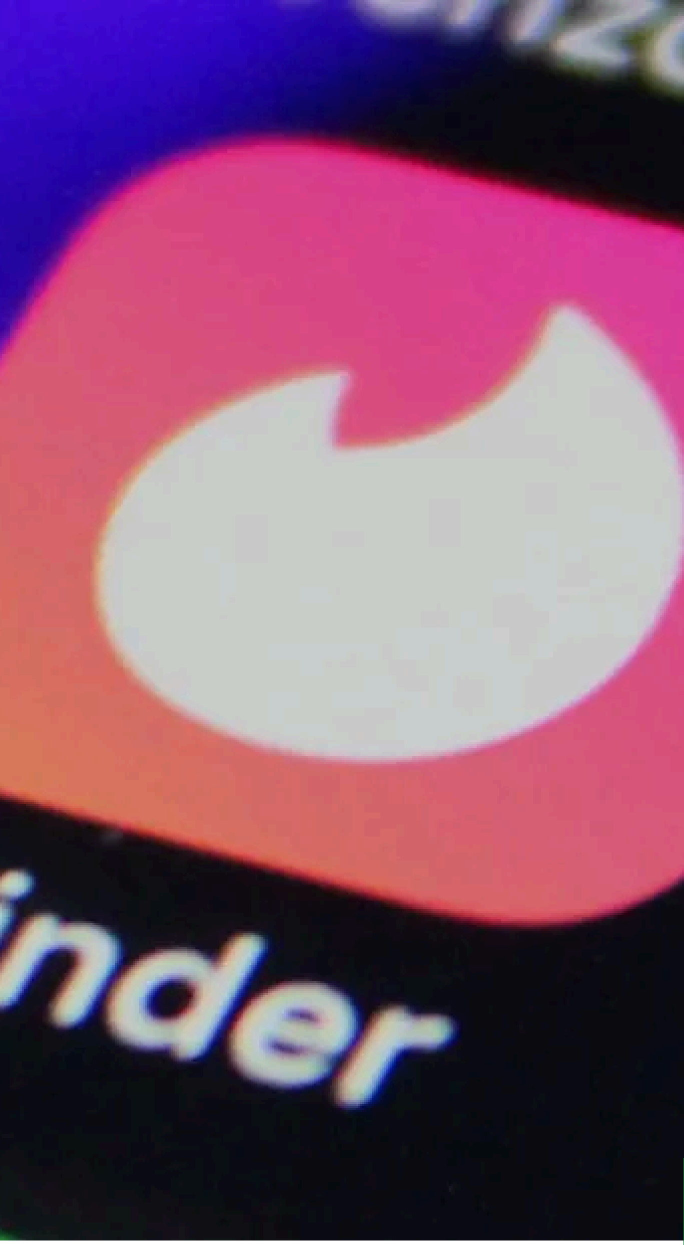

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

APPS

Tinder explores a redesign, dating ‘modes,’ and college-specific features to boost engagement

Ivan Mehta — 6:40 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Tinder is still struggling to generate revenue from its users, as it reported a 7% dip in paying users while its parent company, Match Group, saw a 5% dip in Q2 2025 across all dating apps, including Tinder, Hinge, Match.com, and others.

To boost engagement and push more people to pay for its product, the company has undertaken multiple new initiatives. During Match’s second-quarter earnings call, Match Group CEO Spencer Rascoff said that Tinder will debut a new feature called “modes,” which will allow users to switch between different dating goals to explore new connections in real time. This is similar to a

Latest in Apps

previous option where Tinder allowed users to put their relationship goals directly on their profiles.

Tinder will also explore a broader redesign and other new features, including those aimed at college students, to drive more usage among Gen Z.

Another new feature allows users to like specific parts of a profile, nudging people to start conversations based on those likes, similar to Match's dating app Hinge.

The changes arrive amid a mixed quarter for the dating app giant, which reported flat year-over-year revenue of $864 million and earnings that declined from $133.3 million year-over-year to $122.5 million in Q2. However, the company provided a better-than-expected Q3 outlook with revenue reaching $910-920 million, which boosted its stock post-earnings.

Match also announced it would invest $50 million in product development, as the dating app maker aims to connect with younger Gen Z users and use AI to improve its products.

"We'll take the first steps towards a new UI refresh in Q3 with a cleaner, faster, and more modern look across the entire app," Rascoff said. "We're on track to test version one of a redesigned 'see who likes you' tab this fall with the goal of helping users connect with people they're more likely to be interested in, as well as to drive more revenue," he added.

In the case of the latter, Tinder continues to experiment with AI-powered matching, which it debuted in New Zealand earlier this year. The feature delivers curated matches based on information from your Tinder profile, answers to

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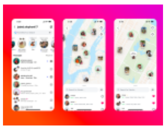

How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

Aisha Malik - 6 hours ago

AI

AI agents aren't the 'new Google,' says Airbnb CEO

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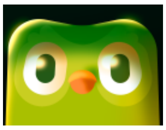


The backlash against Duolingo going 'AI-first' didn't even matter

Amanda Silberling - 11 hours ago

questions, and, optionally, insights from the user's camera roll photos.

Now, the company intends to roll out this feature to more geographies.

"The interactive matching experience we've been testing in New Zealand is specifically designed to appeal to this type of audience [users under 30]: Somebody who doesn't just want to be judged based on their physical appearance. [The feature is for] somebody who instead is willing to put in a little bit of time, answer some questions, and then get a custom result back," Rascoff said.

Plus, Rascoff noted that Tinder is thinking about launching more college-specific features, including allowing users to just search within their college or other selected colleges, to appeal to younger users.

The company also offered an update on Tinder's [Double Date option](), launched in June, that lets users pair up with a friend to match with another couple. The dating company said it saw positive results with 92% of users utilizing the feature being under 30.

IMAGE CREDITS:TINDER

This was Rascoff's first full quarter at the helm of Match Group, as the Zillow Group co-founder and

Match board member was appointed CEO in February.

Earlier this year, the company announced that Faye Iosotaluno would step down from the app's CEO position in July, with Rascoff taking on the role. The company also laid off 13% of its staff (around 325 people) in May, and closed open roles.

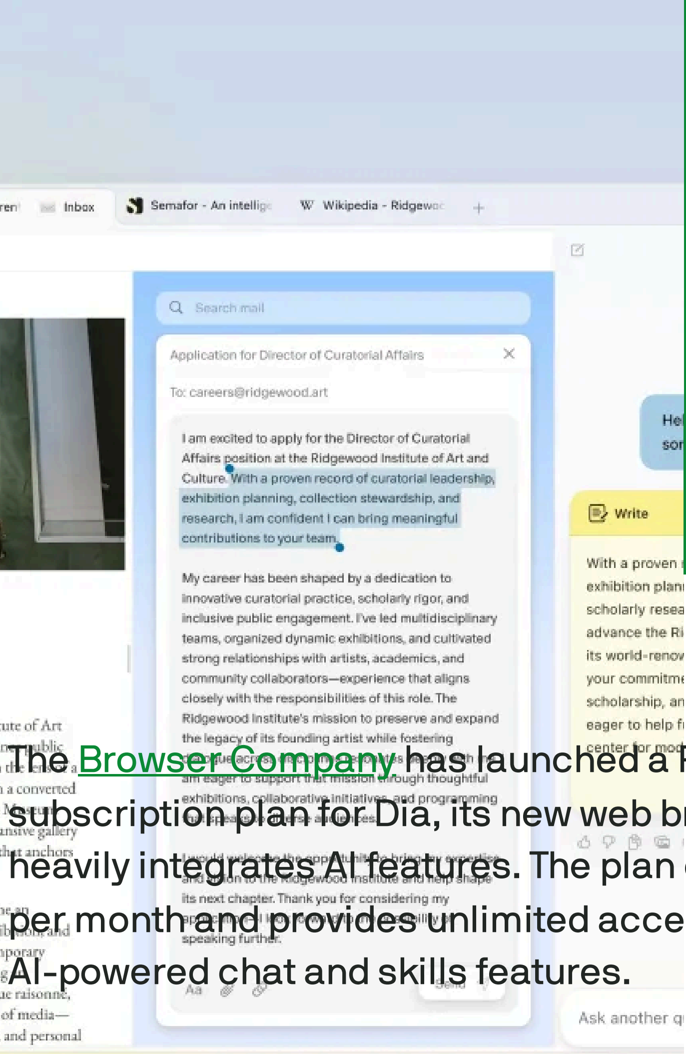
Topics: Apps dating apps Match Group Social Tinder

APPS

The Browser Company launches a $20 monthly

subscription for its AI-powered browser

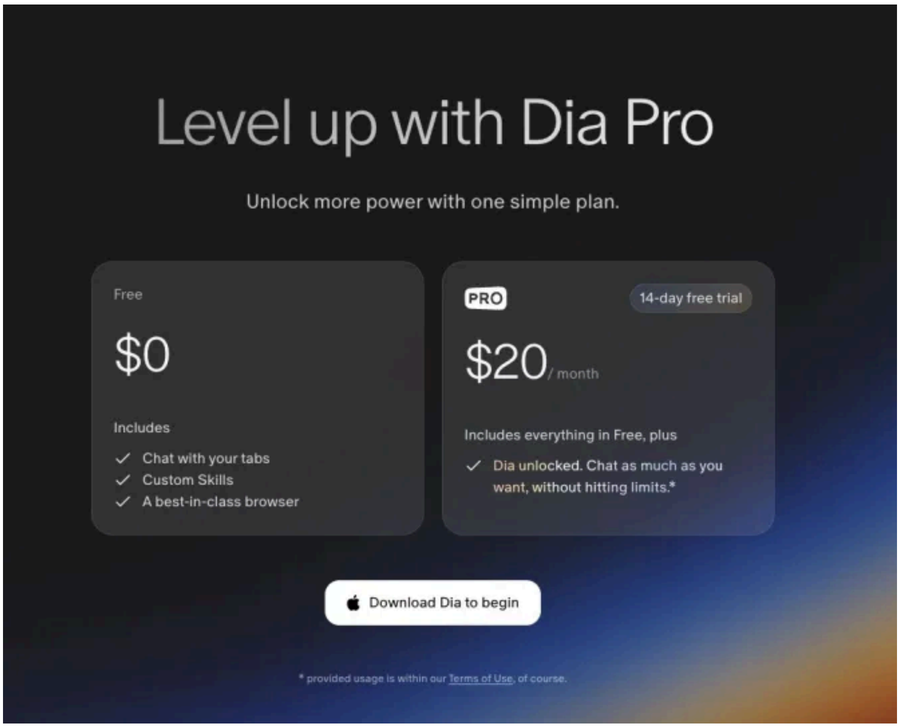
Ivan Mehta — 11:26 PM PDT · August 6, 2025



The [Browser Company](#) has launched a Pro subscription plan for Dia, its new web browser that heavily integrates AI features. The plan costs $20 per month and provides unlimited access to Dia's AI-powered chat and skills features.

The introduction of a paid tier means free users will now face usage limits on AI features. While The Browser Company hasn't specified exact limits, CEO Josh Miller told [The New York Times](#) in July that the browser will remain free for those who use AI features "a few times a week."

IMAGE CREDITS: THE BROWSER COMPANY



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Miller also indicated that the startup plans to offer multiple subscription tiers, ranging from $5 per month to hundreds of dollars monthly. The current $20 plan appears to be one of several options based on different feature sets.

Earlier this week, users on Reddit and Threads noticed that The Browser Company had quietly made the Pro plan available online. However, the company quickly removed the page. Now the subscription option has been restored and can be accessed through Dia's settings page.

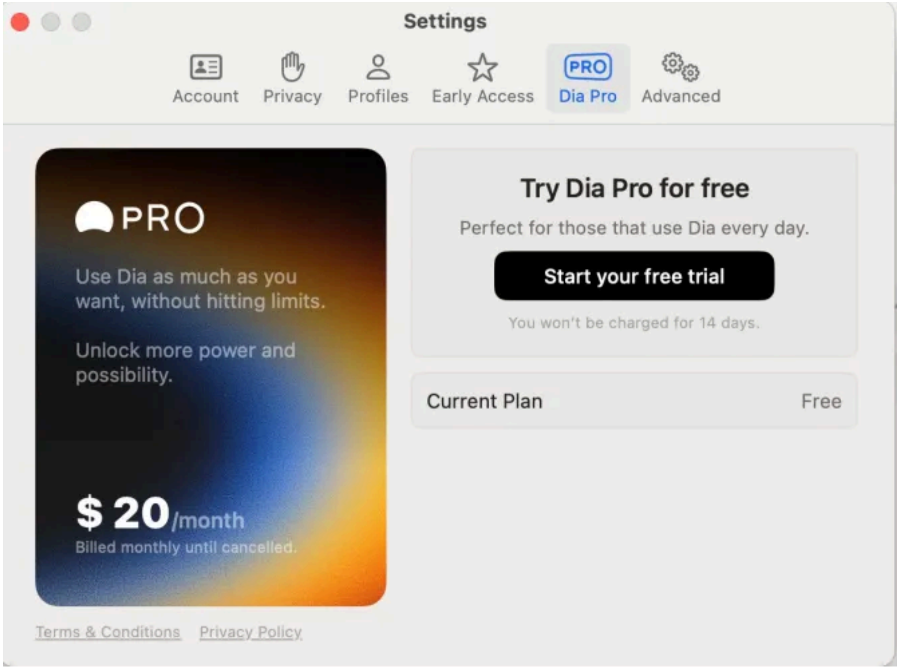

IMAGE CREDITS:SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

The Browser Company, which previously made the Arc browser, has raised $128 million from investors, including Pace Capital, Next Play Ventures, and notable tech execs like LinkedIn's Jeff Weiner, Medium's Ev Williams, Figma's Dylan Field, Notion's Akshay Kothari, and GitHub's Jason Warner. This Pro plan represents the company's first revenue-generating subscription service.

The startup faces growing competition when it comes to AI-enhanced browsers. Perplexity's Comet browser is gaining steam, Opera is also prepping its Neon browser, and incumbents like

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Google and Microsoft are also integrating their AI assistants into their browsers.

Topics: AI browsers Apps dia browser The Browser Company

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VENTURE

Final call: TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 ticket savings end tonight

TechCrunch Events — 6:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

TechCrunch Disrupt 2025 marks 20 years of shaping the startup world — and tonight's your last chance to save up to $675 on your ticket.

From October 27–29, Disrupt returns to Moscone West in San Francisco. Join 10,000+ tech innovators, founders, VCs, and ecosystem builders for three days of high-impact programming, networking, and startup energy.

But first: your savings. You have until **11:59 p.m. PT tonight** to save up to $675. Once the clock strikes midnight, prices jump. Register now.

Why you won't want to miss this 20th-anniversary Disrupt

TechCrunch Disrupt has been the launchpad for breakthroughs and next-generation deals for 20 years. It's not just another tech conference — it's where game-changing innovations are born, powerful connections are made, and ideas turn into action.

One session, one meeting, one moment — that's all it takes to change your trajectory. Disrupt is where startups break out, investors find the next big thing, and industry leaders stay ahead of the curve.

Featured Disrupt 2025 speakers

- Roelof Botha, Sequoia Capital
- Jeff Cardenas, Apptronik
- David George, Andreessen Horowitz
- Alex Kendall, Wayve
- Eunice Kim, Netflix
- Tekedra Mawakana, Waymo
- Alejandro Matamala Ortiz, Runway

- Ryan Petersen, Flexport
- Mati Staniszewski, ElevenLabs
- Astro Teller, X, The Moonshot Factory
- Ethan Thornton, Mach Industries
- Nirav Tolia, Nextdoor
- Raquel Urtasun, Waabi
- Eric Yuan, Zoom
- Sangeen Zeb, GV (Google Ventures)
- ...and many more. New speakers are announced weekly. **Check the speaker page** often.

IMAGE CREDITS:HAJE KAMPS / TECHCRUNCH

Here's what's happening at Disrupt

Four Industry stages + the Disrupt Stage

Dive into the tools, trends, and tactics founders need to grow, scale, and lead in a competitive market. Stay tuned as new sessions are frequently added to **the agenda**.

- **Builders Stage:** Growth playbooks and founder realities
- **AI Stage:** Two days covering agents, creativity, defense, EV, hardware, and regulation
- **Space Stage:** Where tech meets the cosmos
- **Going Public Stage:** Candid lessons from companies that made it

Interactive sessions

Join candid conversations with startup pros in small-group roundtables and breakout sessions. Ask real questions, get unfiltered answers, and gain in-depth insights not covered on the big stages.

IMAGE CREDITS:TECHCRUNCH

Startup Battlefield 200

Watch the top 20 TechCrunch–picked startups pitch live on the Disrupt Stage for a $100,000 equity-free prize — with real-time VC feedback.

Explore what's next

Step into the Expo Hall and meet the startups creating tomorrow's tech. Founders: Want in? Exhibit your startup and get in front of investors, media, and future customers, before tables run out.

Make the right connections

Disrupt isn't about meeting *more* people — it's about meeting the *right* ones. Braindate helps you find those key conversations that move your goals forward, whether in a 1:1 or small-group format.

Additional benefits for investors and founders

The Deal Flow Café is where investors and founders connect over coffee to talk deals, raise rounds, and spark momentum.

In addition to access to the Deal Flow Café, Investor and Founder Pass holders unlock exclusive benefits designed to make an impact:

- **Investors:** Enjoy a curated tour of the Expo Hall with formal introductions to startups that align with your investment focus. Plus, your reserved seat at the exclusive **StrictlyVC** session on Day 2 awaits.

- **Founders:** Get face time with investors actively scouting for their next big bet, whether you're raising now or building for what's next.

IMAGE CREDITS:TECHCRUNCH

Savings disappear after tonight

You've got until **11:59 p.m. PT tonight** to save up to $675 on your Disrupt 2025 ticket. Don't miss one of the most anticipated tech conferences of the year. **Register now** and lock in your savings before prices go up after tonight.

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